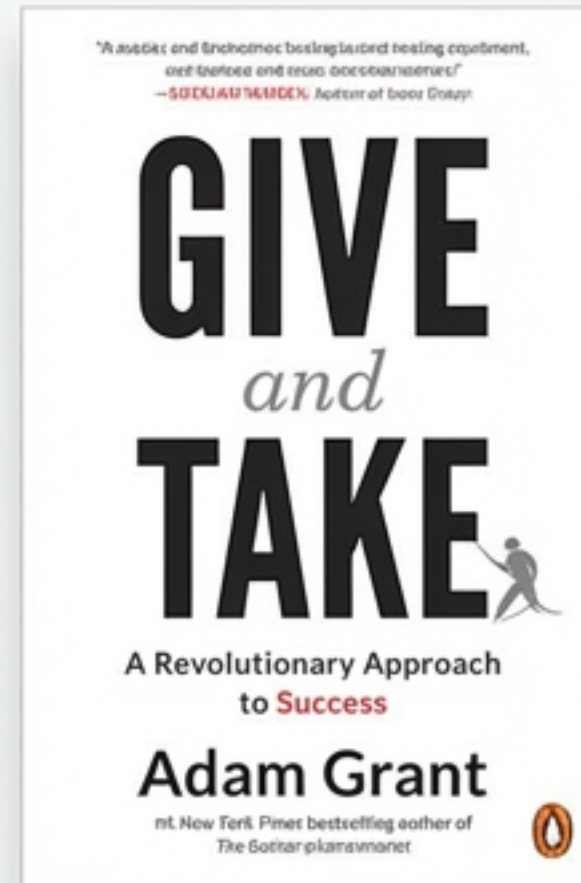




A Presentation Based on the Work of Adam Grant

The principle of give and take; that is diplomacy—give one and take ten. — Mark Twain

The Cost of Being Nice

A Tale of Two Term Sheets

The Standard Approach



Exploding Offers & Tight Deadlines

David Hornik's Approach



Ample White Space & Flexibility

Silicon Valley entrepreneur Danny Shader pitched VC David Hornik. Hornik offered a deal immediately. But unlike standard VCs who use “exploding offers” with tight deadlines, Hornik refused to pressure him. He said, “Take as much time as you need to make the right decision.”

Why the 'Nice Guy' Lost the Deal



Danny Shader (The Entrepreneur)

"My heart said to go with you, but my head said to go with them. I should probably add somebody to the board who will challenge me more."

David Hornik (The VC)

"I've spent a decade building my reputation so this wouldn't happen. How did this happen?"

Result: Shader signed with a competitor who appeared 'tougher'.

The Conventional Wisdom of Success

Motivation + Ability + Opportunity = Success



Reciprocity Style

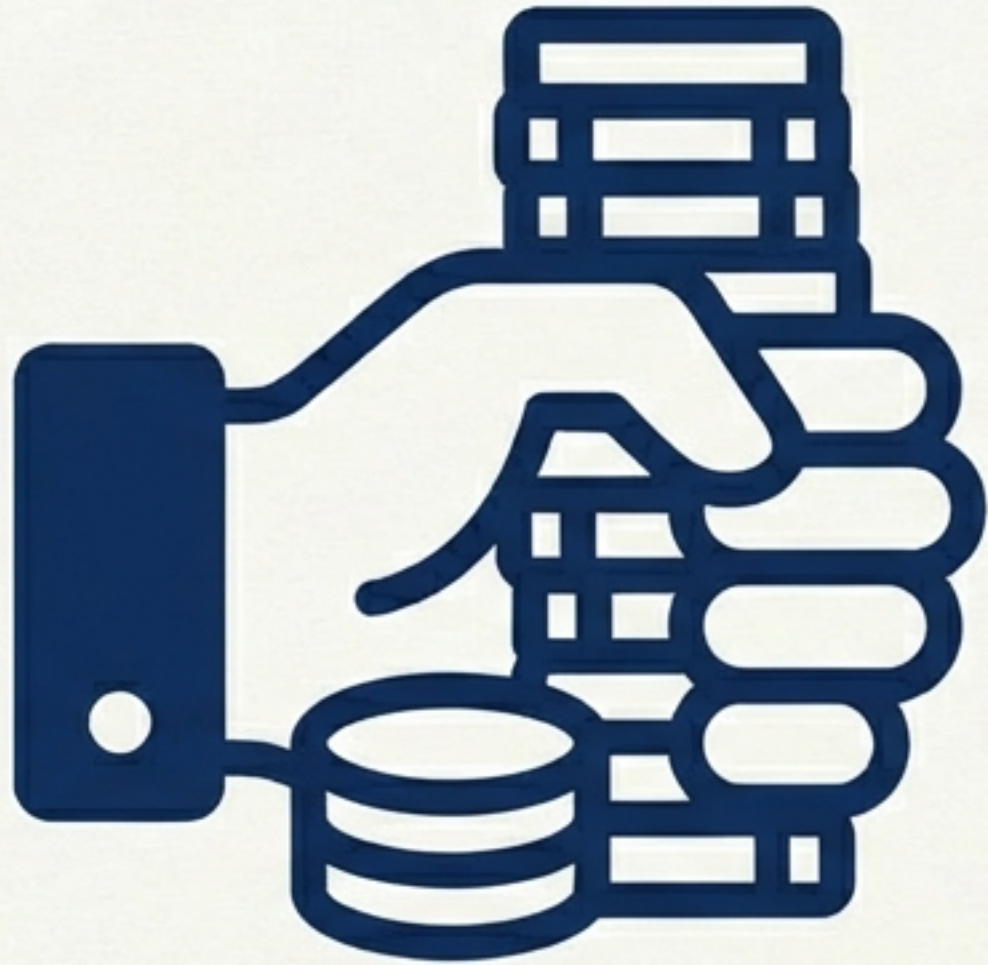
We often neglect the fourth ingredient: How we approach our interactions with others. Every interaction involves a choice: Do we claim value for ourselves, or contribute value to others?

The Three Reciprocity Styles



While people adapt to situations, most develop a primary style at work.

The Taker



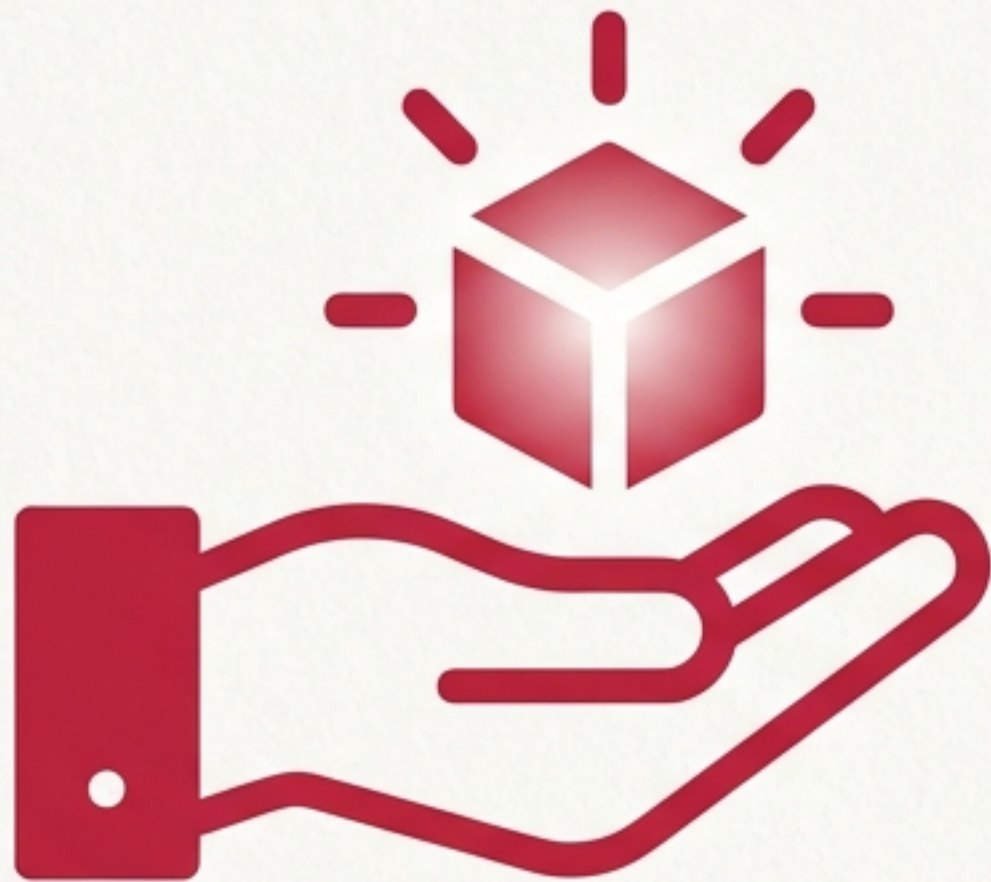
- **Motto:** “What can you do for me?”
- **Strategy:** Self-promotion and value claiming.
- **Worldview:** A competitive, dog-eat-dog world. Success means being better than others.
- **Behavior:** Helps others only strategically when the personal benefit outweighs the cost. Not cruel, but self-protective.

The Matcher



- **Motto:** “Quid pro quo” (This for that).
- **Strategy:** Fairness and even exchanges. Preserving the balance of giving and getting.
- **Worldview:** Relationships are governed by tit-for-tat.
- **Behavior:** If they do a favor, they expect one in return. This is the most common style in the workplace.

The Giver



- **Motto:** “What can I do for you?”
- **Strategy:** Helpful without strings attached. Tilting reciprocity in the other person’s favor.
- **Worldview:** Focus on others’ needs rather than what they can offer in return.
- **Behavior:** Sharing time, energy, knowledge, and connections. Rare in the workplace due to fear of exploitation.

The Paradox: Who Sinks to the Bottom?



The Givers

1. **Engineering:** The least productive employees were those who gave more than they received.
2. **Medicine:** Students with the lowest grades had the highest “giver” scores.
3. **Sales:** Givers generated 2.5x less revenue than takers or matchers.

Helping others prevented them from doing their own work.

If Givers Are at the Bottom, Who Is at the Top?



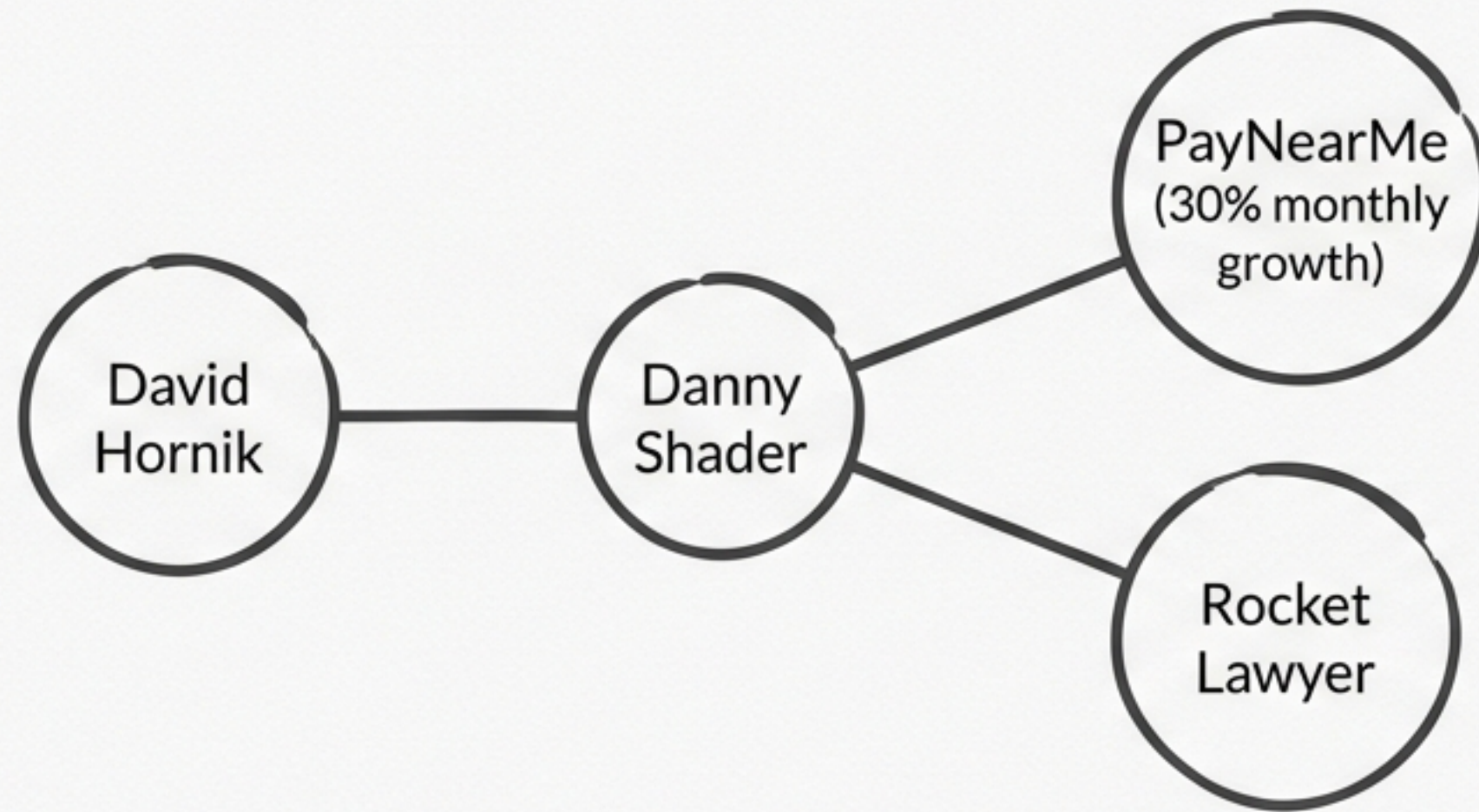
Is it the aggressive **Takers**?
Or the fair **Matchers**?

The Reveal: Givers Dominate the Top



Top sales performers were **Givers**, averaging **50% more revenue**.
Top medical students were **Givers**.

Playing the Long Game: Hornik's Return



Danny Shader felt guilty about the rejection. He invited Hornik to invest in a later round and became his biggest advocate.

Hornik's Signing Rate: 89%

(Industry Avg: 50%)

Reputation Capital



The Taker Tax: Envy and enemies.



The Ripple Effect: Allies and advocates.

“It’s easier to win if everybody wants you to win.” — Randy Komisar

“The Matcher’s Blind Spot”

The Story of Peter Audet, Financial Advisor



The Lead: A “scrap metal worker” with a small \$70k account.

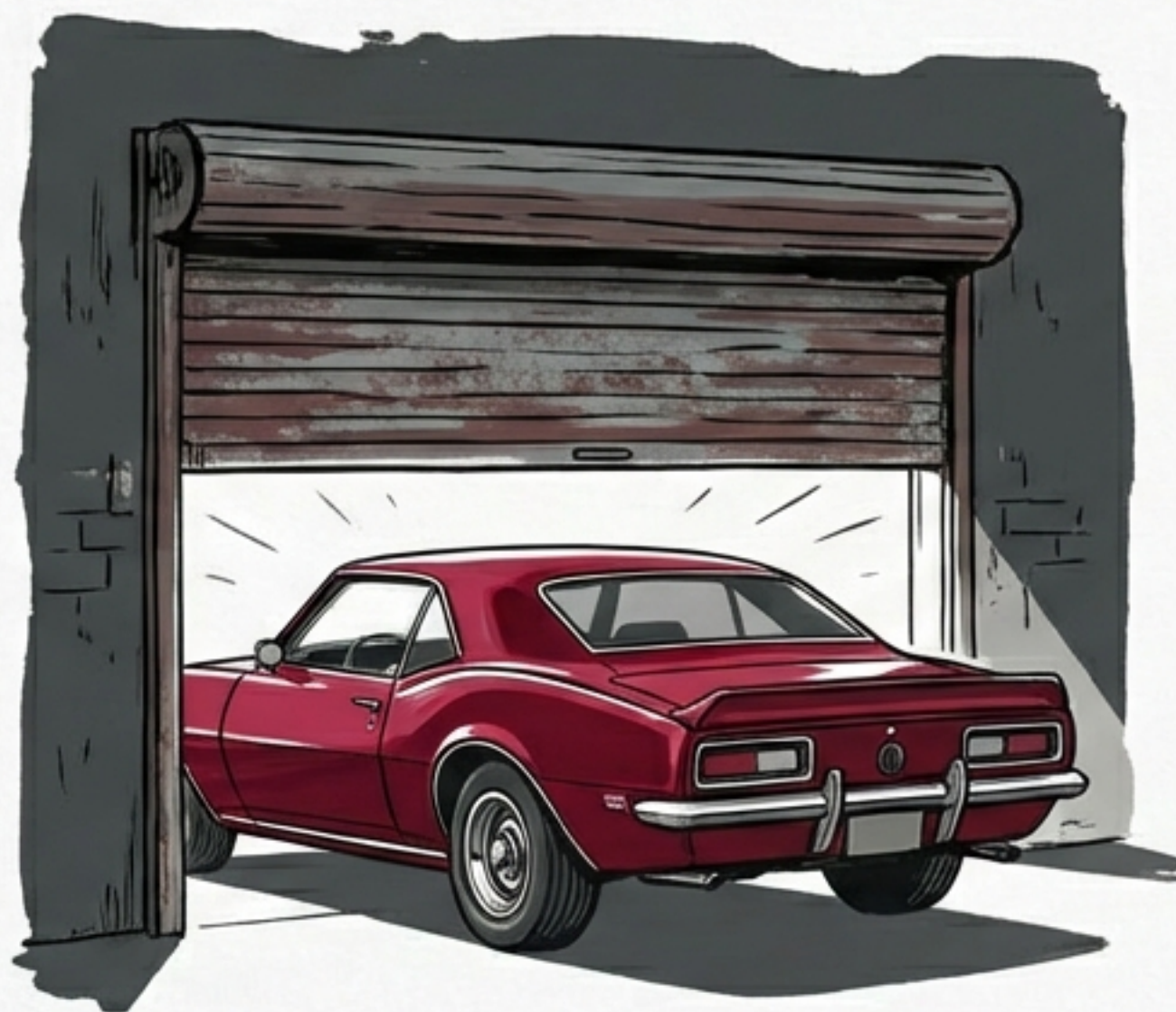
The Matcher’s Calculation:

The Matcher colleague refused the visit. The ROI was too low. “It was beneath everybody.”

The Giver’s Approach:

Audet went anyway. “You can’t just ignore someone because you don’t think they’re important enough.”

The Hidden Opportunity



The Discovery: The client owned a lucrative scrap metal empire. Assets included vintage cars and a \$1.4m cash home purchase.

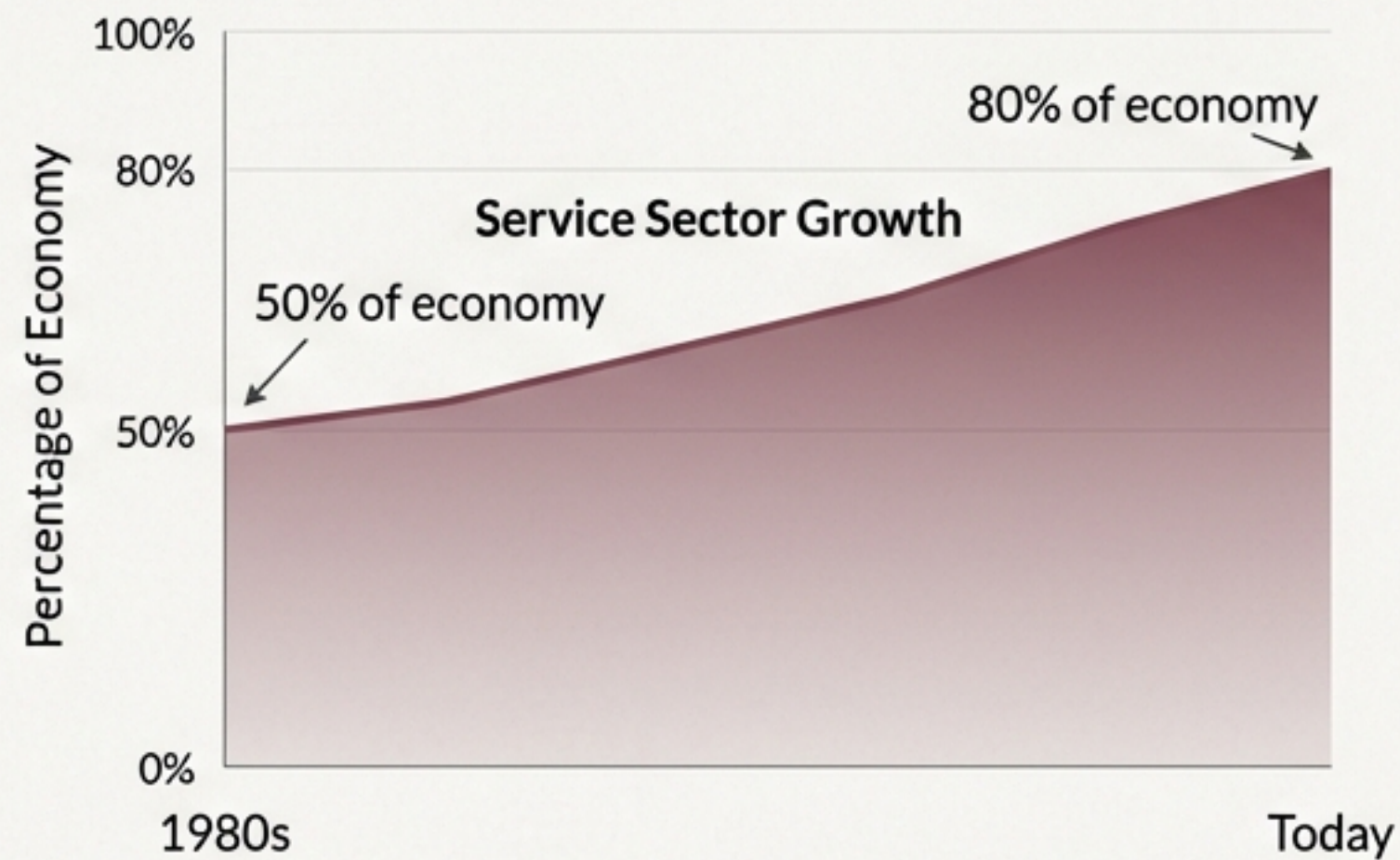
The Result: Client fees multiplied 100x the following year.

Takeaway: Matchers restrict themselves to obvious trades. Givers cast a wider net and find diamonds in the rough.

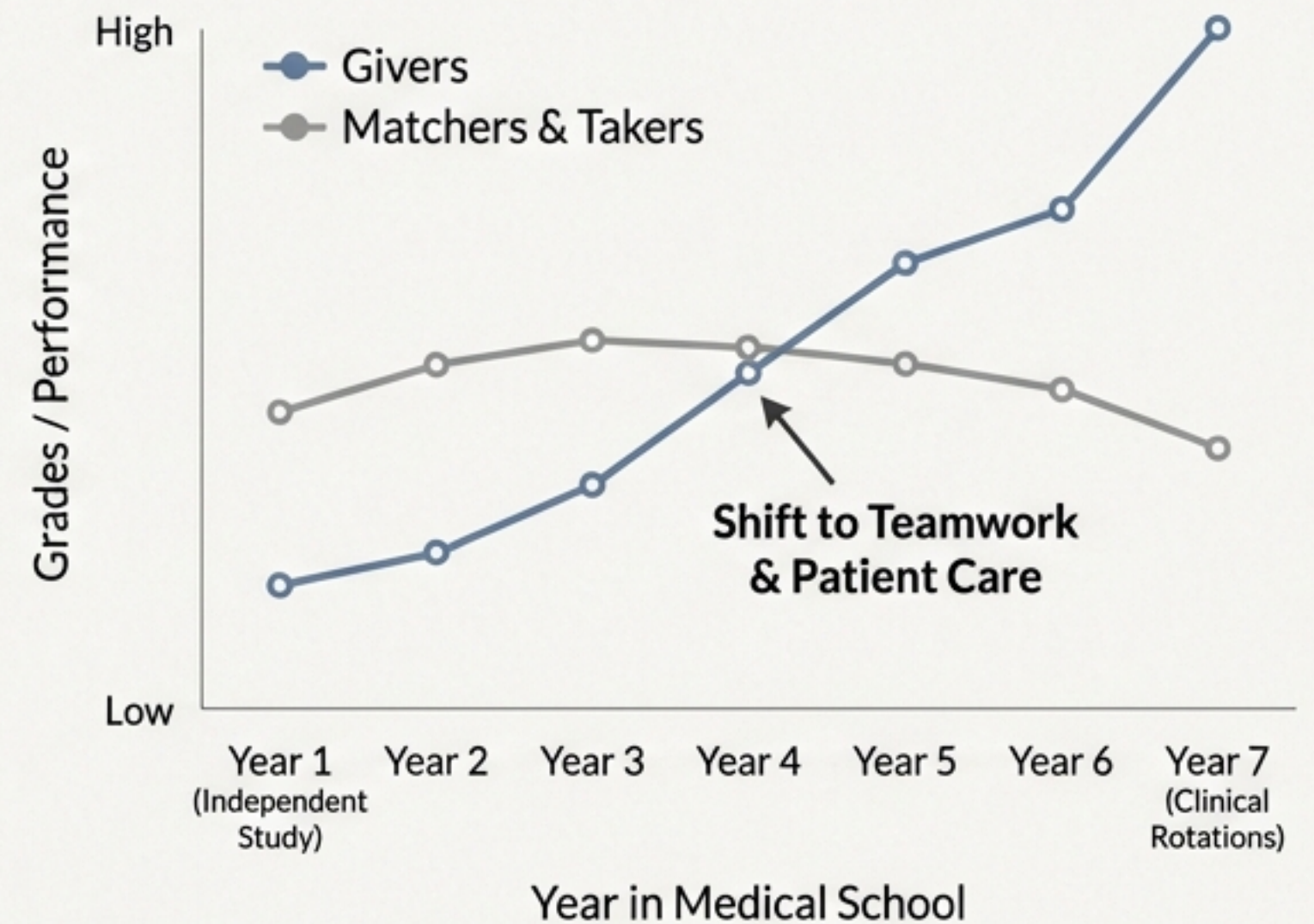
Why the Giver Advantage is Growing



The Rise of Service



The Teamwork Effect



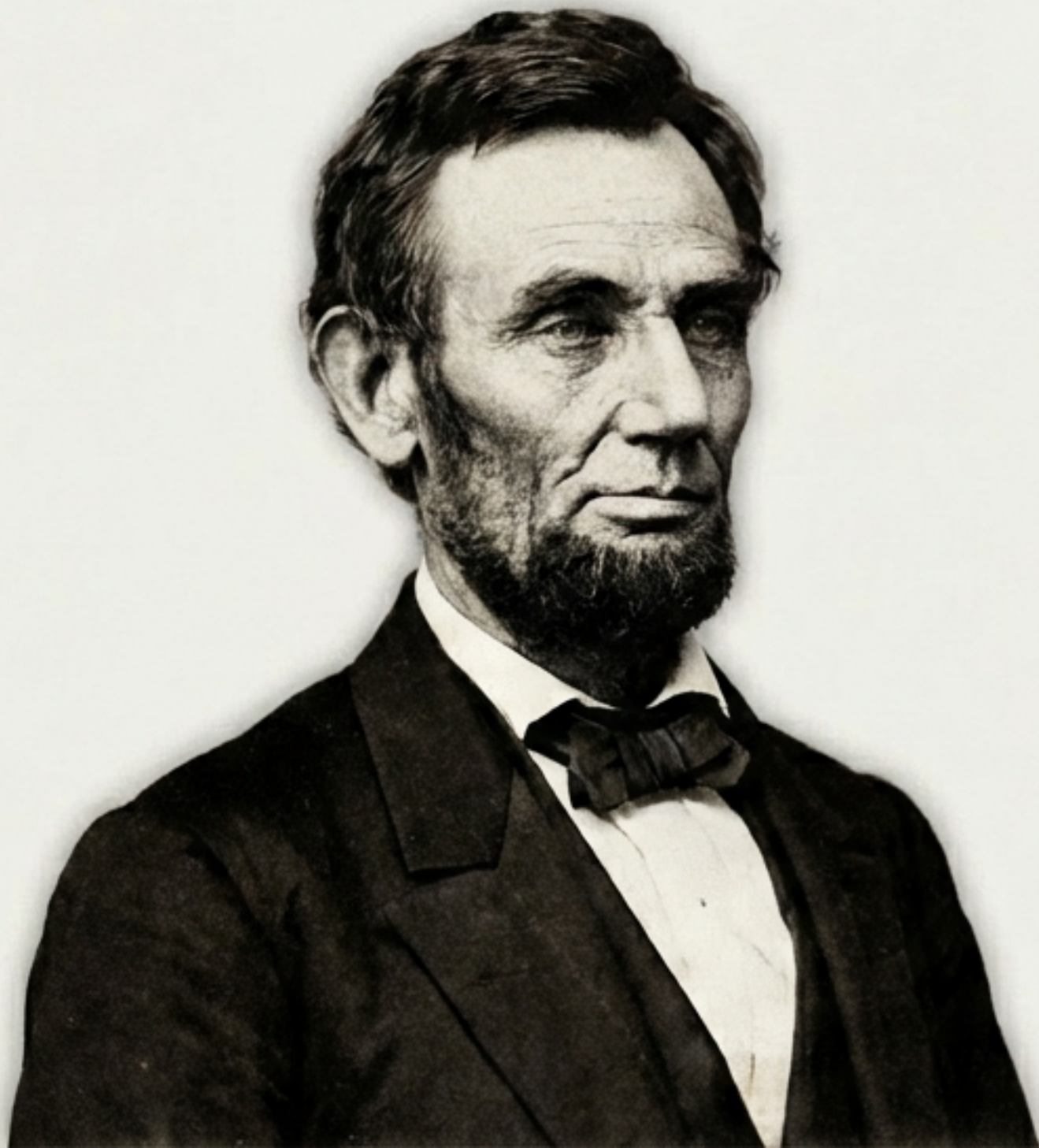
The Case of “Sampson’s Ghost”



Story: Candidate “Sampson” was running for Senate. He had 47% of the vote. To prevent a corrupt rival from winning, he dropped out and gave all his votes to Lyman Trumbull (who had only 5%).

Result: Sampson lost. He was labeled a pushover who lacked the “killer instinct”.

From Pushover to President

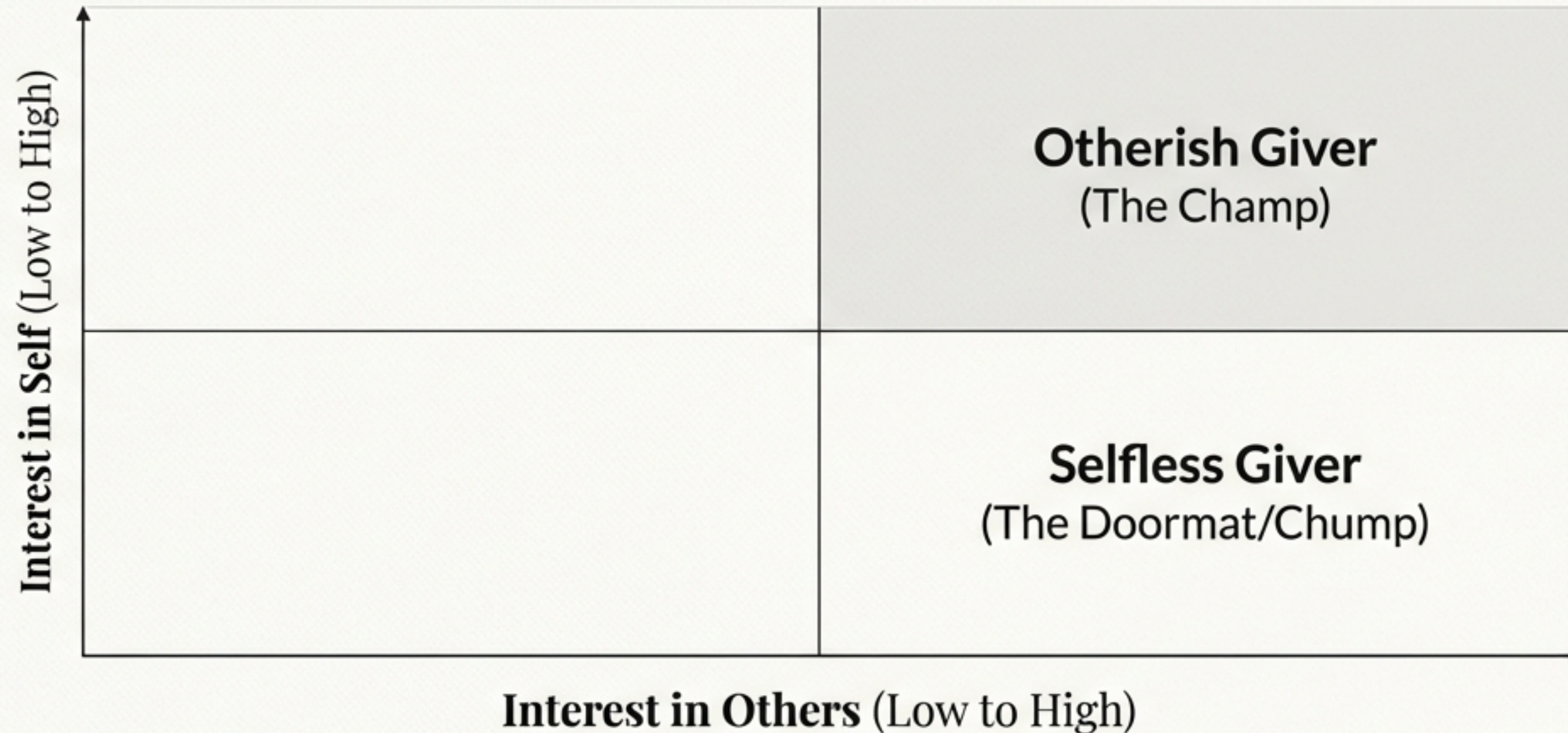


‘Sampson’ was Abraham Lincoln.

The Payoff: Trumbull became a fierce ally who helped Lincoln win the Presidency years later.

“I had no right to deprive the country of their services.” — Lincoln on appointing his rivals to his cabinet.

The Difference Between Champs and Chumps



Successful *Givers* are ambitious. They don't ignore their own needs; they use giving as the path to achieving them.

Success is Not a Zero-Sum Game



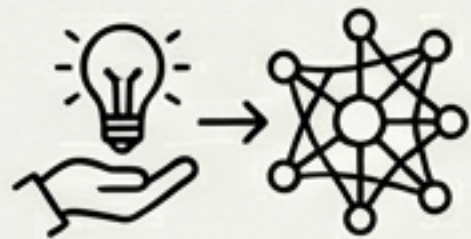
1. **Reciprocity Style** is a key driver of success.



2. The **Giver Curve** is U-shaped (avoid the bottom, aim for the top).



3. The **Long Game** favors Givers (Reputation Capital).



4. Shift from Claiming Value to Creating Value.

The Final Choice

“Every man must decide whether he will walk in the light of creative **altruism** or in the darkness of destructive selfishness.” — Martin Luther King Jr.

The path to the top is wider than we think.